

Four jurisdictions, compared

Residency routes, entry thresholds and what they really cost

One main applicant, no dependants. Entry and the first renewal.

The four questions, asked of each

JURISDICTION	ROUTE	FROM	FIRST PERMIT	TAX REGIME
Portugal	Golden Visa (fund)	€500,000	90 days by law, a year or more in practice	IFICI, 20% flat for 10 years
Greece	Golden Visa (property)	€400,000	Lawful residence on filing, card in months	Non-dom, €100,000 a year, separate €500,000 investment
Malta	Permanent residence programme	€375,000	Not published; 6–12 months in practice	Remittance basis — but the permit gives no tax residence
UAE	Golden Visa (property)	AED 2,000,000	7–10 working days published, 2–4 weeks end to end	No personal income tax

What it really costs in the first year

The threshold is the investment alone. Transfer taxes, professional and government fees and the first renewal are not optional — everyone pays them, every time.

Portugal

Advertised €500,000 Everything else €28,000 Real, first year €528,000

Greece

Advertised €400,000 Everything else €35,000 Real, first year €435,000

Malta

Advertised €375,000 Everything else €126,000 Real, first year €501,000

UAE

Advertised €466,000 Everything else €31,000 Real, first year €497,000

Verified against primary sources on 23 August 2026 — statutes, ministry tariffs and official fee schedules. Figures are for ONE main applicant and cover entry and the first renewal; dependants are priced differently in every jurisdiction and are not included. Amounts in euro; the UAE threshold is AED 2,000,000 converted at 4.288 on the same date.

Cyprus is in our table on the site and is not in this document: its figures rest on secondary sources, and a PDF is the wrong place to publish a number nobody has read from a statute.